

GPT2-Clone Public

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iqbal-sk Update README.md to provide comprehensive project overview and usa... ...

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📁 modules	Corrected wrong implementati...	8 months ago
📁 utils	Implemented utility function fo...	8 months ago
📄 GPTModel.py	Implemented GPT Class	8 months ago
📄 README.md	Update README.md to provid...	last month
📄 requirements.txt	Added requirements.txt	8 months ago
📄 train_gutenberg.py	Included	8 months ago

Hands-on GPT-2 built from scratch —clean Transformer blocks, practical training pipeline, and inference tools—showcasing ML systems craftsmanship.

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GPT-2 Clone (From Scratch, PyTorch)

A clean, from-scratch implementation of a GPT-2–style Transformer language model in PyTorch, including all core building blocks (Multi-Head Attention, GELU MLP, LayerNorm, causal masking), a data pipeline, configurable training loop with warmup+cosine decay, checkpointing, and text generation utilities. Trains on plain `.txt` corpora (e.g., Project Gutenberg) and logs metrics/samples to Weights & Biases.

This project showcases systems-level deep learning skills: implementing core transformer components correctly and readably, designing a practical training loop, and exposing ergonomic utilities for evaluation and inference.

Highlights

- Minimal, readable implementation of GPT-2 components without heavy frameworks.
- Configurable model sizes, including a debug-friendly small config and a 355M-style setup.
- Tokenization via `tiktoken` (GPT-2 BPE), end-of-text handling, and sliding-window dataset creation.
- Training loop with AdamW, decoupled weight decay (parameter-wise groups), linear warmup, cosine annealing, and gradient clipping.
- Checkpointing (interrupt-safe), validation, and sample generation during training.
- Device support for CUDA, Apple Silicon (MPS), and CPU.
- W&B integration out-of-the-box for metrics, gradients, and sample logging.

What This Project Does

- Implements a GPT-2-like model end-to-end:
 - Token and positional embeddings, $N \times$ Transformer blocks, final LayerNorm, tied output head.
 - Multi-Head Attention uses PyTorch's `scaled_dot_product_attention` with causal masking.
 - Feed-forward MLP with GELU, residual connections, and dropout.
- Provides a practical training/evaluation pipeline:
 - Text dataset windows created via a stride over token IDs for efficient batching.

Releases

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Languages

● Python 100.0%

Suggested workflows

Based on your tech stack
annealing, and gradient clipping.

Pylint

Configure

Lint a Python application with pylint.

SLSA Generic generator

Configure

Generate SLSA3 provenance for your existing release workflows

Python package

Configure

Create and test a Python package on multiple Python

- Per-book train/val split, periodic evaluation and plotting of losses.
- Learning rate schedule: linear warmup then cosine decay; gradient clipping after warmup.
- Checkpoints saved periodically and at the end; supports resume.

3. Includes simple, flexible text generation utilities:

- Greedy decoding, temperature scaling, top-k sampling, and early stop on EOS.

versions.

[More workflows](#)

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Repository Structure

```
GPTModel.py          # GPT-2 style model (embeddings, blocks, head)
modules/
  layers/
    multi_head_attention.py # MHA with causal SDPA
    feed_forward.py        # GELU MLP
    layer_norm.py          # Custom LayerNorm
    gelu.py                # GELU activation
  data/
    Datasets.py           # GPTDataset + DataLoader factory (tiktoken)
  utils/
    training.py           # Train/val dataloader helpers
    loss.py               # Loss, evaluation, and plotting
    generation.py         # Encoding/decoding and sampling utilities
    train_gutenberg.py    # End-to-end training script w/ W&B
    requirements.txt
```



Quick Start

1) Setup

```
python -m venv .venv && source .venv/bin/activate # optional
pip install -r requirements.txt
# Optional but recommended for logging
wandb login
```



2) Prepare Data

- Place plain text files under a directory (default: `data/sample_train_data`).
- For Project Gutenberg or similar corpora, ensure license compliance and preprocess into `.txt` files.

Example layout:

```
data/
  sample_train_data/
    book1.txt
    book2.txt
    ...
```



3) Train

Debug-sized model (fast iteration):

```
python train_gutenberg.py \
  --data_dir data/sample_train_data \
  --output_dir model_checkpoints \
  --n_epochs 1 \
  --batch_size 4 \
  --lr 1e-4 \
  --debug True
```



Larger 355M-style model:

```
python train_gutenberg.py \
  --data_dir data/sample_train_data \
  --output_dir model_checkpoints \
  --n_epochs 1 \
  --batch_size 4 \
  --lr 1e-4
```



Key flags:

- `--data_dir` : Directory with `.txt` files.
- `--output_dir` : Where to save checkpoints and plots.
- `--n_epochs` , `--batch_size` , `--lr` : Usual training knobs.
- `--debug` : Switches to a smaller, quicker model config.
- `--print_sample_iter` : Iterations between sample generations during training.
- `--eval_freq` : Evaluation cadence (train/val loss).
- `--save_ckpt_freq` : Checkpoint save cadence.
- `--load_model_path` / `--load_optimizer_path` : Resume from checkpoints.

4) Resume Training

```
python train_gutenberg.py \
  --data_dir data/sample_train_data \
  --output_dir model_checkpoints \
  --load_model_path model_checkpoints/checkpoint_000100.pt \
  --load_optimizer_path model_checkpoints/checkpoint_000100.pt
```



5) Generate Text (Standalone)

```
import torch, tiktoken
from GPTModel import GPTModel
from utils.generation import text_to_token_ids, token_ids_to_text, generate

# Match the config used for training
GPT_CONFIG_355M = {
    "vocab_size": 50257,
    "context_length": 1024,
    "emb_dim": 1024,
    "n_heads": 16,
    "n_layers": 24,
    "drop_rate": 0.1,
    "qkv_bias": False,
}

device = torch.device("cuda" if torch.cuda.is_available() else ("mps" if torch.backends.mps.is_available() else "cpu")
model = GPTModel(GPT_CONFIG_355M).to(device)

# Load a trained checkpoint
ckpt = torch.load("model_checkpoints/final_checkpoint.pt", map_location=device)
model.load_state_dict(ckpt["model_state_dict"])
model.eval()

tokenizer = tiktoken.get_encoding("gpt2")
prompt = "Every effort moves you"
idx = text_to_token_ids(prompt, tokenizer).to(device)

with torch.no_grad():
    out = generate(model, idx, max_new_tokens=80, context_size=GPT_CONFIG_355M["context_length"], temperature=0.8, t
    print(token_ids_to_text(out, tokenizer))
```



Model And Training Details

- Architecture: Token/position embeddings → $N \times$ {LayerNorm → MHA (causal) → Dropout → Residual, LayerNorm → MLP(GELU) → Dropout → Residual} → final LayerNorm → linear vocab head.

- Attention: Uses `torch.nn.functional.scaled_dot_product_attention(..., is_causal=True)` for correctness and efficiency.
- Optimizer: AdamW with decoupled weight decay; parameters are grouped so weight decay applies only to matrix-like tensors (`ndim >= 2`).
- Schedule: Linear warmup → cosine decay; gradient clipping after warmup.
- Tokenization: `tiktoken` GPT-2 BPE with `<|endoftext|>` support.
- Evaluation: Periodic train/val cross-entropy; loss curves saved to `losses.pdf` in `output_dir` .
- Devices: CUDA, Apple MPS, or CPU are auto-detected.

Installation Notes

- Python 3.10+ recommended.
- PyTorch 2.0+ required (for SDPA and performance). Install the wheel appropriate for your platform.
- `wandb` is optional but recommended; run `wandb login` before training to enable logging.

Why This Project Stands Out

- From-scratch correctness: Each building block is implemented explicitly for clarity, with readable tensor shapes and minimal abstraction.
- Practical training pipeline: Warmup+cosine schedule, gradient clipping, and checkpointing mirror modern LLM training best practices.
- Ergonomic utilities: Tokenization helpers, sampling strategies, and progress ETA make the code pleasant to use and extend.
- Clean, modular code: Easy to adapt to different model sizes or datasets.

Roadmap / Ideas

- Add byte-level tokenization fallback and Unicode normalization utilities.
- Add mixed precision (AMP) + gradient accumulation for larger effective batch sizes.
- Weight tying between token embeddings and output head to reduce params.
- Better dataset builders and streaming loaders for massive corpora.
- Unit tests and micro-benchmarks for attention kernels.

Acknowledgements

- Inspired by the GPT-2 architecture (Radford et al.) and modern training practices.

Uses `tiktoken` for GPT-2 BPE and `M3B` for embedding training.